



SHARKS

Sharks are the best hunters in the sea. With their terrible teeth and huge jaws, they can tear up seals, turtles, fish, and even wooden boats! Tiger sharks and great white sharks sometimes bite people, but most sharks are more scared of us and soon swim away.



See how big this jaw is!

Sharks are like a swimming nose. They can smell injured animals and other food that is hundreds of yards away.

All living animals produce a small amount of electricity. You cannot sense it, but sharks can. Little dimples on their head work like television aerials to tell them where animals are hiding.

Five gill slits on each side of the head let water pass through the shark's gills.



Teeth as sharp as knives

Shark teeth can cut through skin and crunch up bones, but they soon get dull. Each tooth only lasts for a few weeks, then it falls out and is replaced by a new one. Basking sharks eat plankton so they don't need any teeth!

Dorsal fin

Pectoral fin



Sand tiger shark

Super swimmer

A typical shark swims by bending from side to side. First it moves its head, then its body, and last of all its long tail. This wave travels down its body, pushing the shark through the sea.

Shark attack!

Just before they bite, sharks bend their noses up and move their teeth forward.

Great white shark

Blue shark

